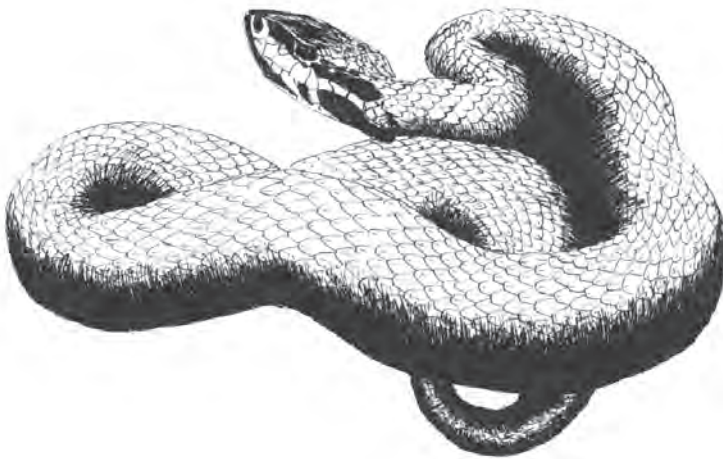




LAW SCHOOL DOMINATION



If the postwar period had been a second springtime for the tribe, then summer began with the election of Joe Segor as Chief on Wednesday, May 7, 1958. Iron Arrow entered nearly a decade of domination by its members from the School of Law. Like the towering thunder heads of Florida's summer, the tribe's horizons filled with the looming personages of these lawyer Chiefs: Joe Segor, Blas Herrero, Joe Martinez, Ed Rubinoff, Barry Richard, and Tom Spencer. Rodney Mandelstam, Marshall Shapo, David Yelen, Steve Miller, and Russell Ehasz, though not lawyers, or not yet lawyers at the time they held office, nevertheless added strength and continuity to these years. One after the other they appeared in the distance, rose higher, and went their ways. And instead of the flash and thunder of lightning, tribal walls reverberated with the boom and crash of warring political factions. They were furious and exciting years.

One of the best stories to come out of these times is also one of the most

AN IRON ARROW ELECTION

revealing. In the legal profession of Florida, Iron Arrow membership is a prestigious ornament indeed. Other trophies include editorship of the Law Review, and membership in Wig and Robe. Thus, the battle lines were drawn between two law school fraternities, Phi Delta Phi and Delta Theta Phi; each clashing for





the first place trophy in the Iron Arrow spring elections. Not only campus and professional prestige were at stake, but also pride in politics well done.

On this stage then, one of Iron Arrow's greatest election stories was played. As members assembled for the 1963 election of officers, they did so with smiles, plans, and considerable anticipation. With resounding and splendid speeches, each faction put forth its nomination. Seconding speeches were made with oratory such as can only spill from lawyers.

The candidates left the room then to talk and smoke, confident or concerned, as the case may be. Inside the room, however, the discussion soon filled with signals and rhetoric, each faction, in turn, as advocate, prosecutor, or public defender.

It soon became apparent that either law fraternity candidate outside, if elected, would send half the members assembled away in rage. Each faction began to convince the other that their nominees in the hallway, whatever their merits, would tear the tribe apart.

So, unknown to those outside, the discussion in the room began to focus instead upon a dark horse nominee. Within minutes, the two men so recently the objects of intricate strategies and sterling oratory were recalled before the tribe. The presiding officer, explaining that neither had won, announced the election of Rodney Mandelstam. It is said that Rodney smiled a great deal after that.¹⁰⁶

The contributions of the lawyer Chiefs were several. After Martinez appealed to members to return their Seminole jackets after tapping week, it soon became policy that all members should purchase their own. In immediate



¹⁰⁶ Story an approximation of actual events which has been embellished.





THE LAWYER CHIEFS

consequence of this policy change, membership fees were raised for initiates, so that the cost of their jackets were included. With members purchasing their own jackets, individual tastes began to dictate the background colors. The traditional orange jackets soon began to be interspersed with royal blue, turquoise, green, yellow, red, purple, and black. Martinez and Rubinoff were the first Chiefs to wear white jackets. By 1975, Walt Kichefski had ordered a jacket with patterns of his own choosing: a row of “hurricane warning flags,” a row depicting goal posts, and another row symbolizing a referee with up stretched arms.

Other traditions began. Chief Ed Rubinoff (1965-66) asked all Iron Arrow members at the Homecoming football game to join him on the Orange Bowl field for a pregame victory line-up. Tom Spencer in 1967, produced the first Iron Arrow directory, an important contribution to tribal records and cohesiveness. Spencer also suggested the possibility of an Iron Arrow tapping mound and monument as a year-long symbol of Iron Arrow’s presence on the campus. The next year, Russell Ehasz, a student of architecture, (who became the last Chief of the Law School years) designed the monument and tapping mound in use today.

What forces were at work through these years that produced a law school monopoly in Iron Arrow? Ed Rubinoff’s explanation seems simplest and best: “Of the seniors tapped for Iron Arrow and returning to the University the next year, the only schools represented were the Schools of Medicine and Law. Since medical students had no time whatsoever, only the law students were usu-

BITS AND PIECES

ally available.”¹⁰⁷

Rubinoff remembers that Chink Whitten, for whom the present Student Union building is named, “was like a father to me.” Among students, Chink was famous for the long hours he devoted to their activities “...the job killed him.”¹⁰⁸ Among his fellow Iron Arrows, who elected him Faculty Advisor seven times during his nine years in the society, Whitten was famous for the initiation stew he cooked on those long, cold winter nights in the Everglades. On initiation nights, he used to tell his children that he was going to the Everglades “to sleep in a tree.”¹⁰⁹

The Law School domination of Iron Arrow was opposed by Whitten, as it was by Jack Kelsey and Thurston Adams, primarily on the grounds that it

¹⁰⁷ Rubinoff, Edward G., conversation with the author, December 4, 1975.

¹⁰⁸ Ibid.



made the organization “too one-sided.” Even so, there was deep mutual respect and warm personal regard within the tribe. When Chink died of a heart attack, Iron Arrow’s Thomas Spencer, William Gilchrist, Skip Flynn, “Doc” Ridenour, and Jim Fleming were his pallbearers.

And what about the politics? Could it be practiced and the tribe’s selection meetings be conducted so that the honor of membership would be maintained? One Chief’s recollection of the times sums it up best: “Iron Arrow was the one organization in my whole life in which I tried to be as completely apolitical as I could.”¹¹⁰ They were furious and exciting and honorable times.



¹⁰⁹ McKenry, Kay, conversation with the author, 1974.

¹¹⁰ Rubinoff, Edward G., as above.





MEDICAL SCHOOL CAMPUS

A Personal History - Diana Lopez - 1963

When we walk around in the 21st Century through our beautiful University of Miami campuses, it is hard to visualize the situation in 1926 when our Alma Mater first opened its doors. Although the University was chartered in 1925 by a group of concerned citizens who wanted to have higher education in their community, the grand opening was scheduled to occur in the Fall of 1926. But misfortune was ahead as a violent hurricane that caused misery and destruction swept through South Florida on September 17 and 18 of that year. That hurricane and the collapse of the Florida land boom washed away the grand plans for a special campus to match the Spanish environment of Coral Gables. Instead, classes started in October, 1926, in a partially completed building that was supposed to have been a hotel; classrooms were created by partitioning areas with cardboard covered studding, thus the nickname, “cardboard college”.

This “cardboard” university lasted for many years and, indeed, survived even after our beautiful Coral Gables campus was inaugurated. I remember taking some graduate classes in the “North Campus” building at University Drive between 1965 and 1966!

My association with the University of Miami started in 1963 when Dr. Henry King Stanford was president. I was hired as a laboratory technician by the late Dr. LaRoy S. Dietrich from the Department of Biochemistry. His laboratory was situated on the 6th floor of the Medical Research Building which is now attached to the Rosenstiel Building on the Medical School campus. I had a degree of Doctor of Natural Sciences from the University of Havana, Cuba, and had recently emigrated to the United States. I remember that one of my first tasks was to kill a mouse and extract the Ehrlich-Lettre’ ascites tumor cells that had been implanted in its peritoneum. I had never killed a mouse before, but I said to myself, “This is not a time for cowardice!”

The School of Medicine was the last to be established under the Ashe presidency and was partly located in the servant’s quarters of what is now the Biltmore Hotel on Anastasia Avenue, and partly at Jackson Memorial Hospital. The School had been founded in 1952 and had not yet achieved its national prominence, however, there were several wonderful professors devoted to biomedical research that served as role models to me and other individuals. Inspired by their dedication, I applied in 1965 to the Graduate program in Microbiology since that discipline paralleled my interests. Little did I suspect that within 20 years all current research among biomedical sciences would be so very close. And molecular and cell biology is the basis of seemingly diverse disciplines such as Physiology, Microbiology, Pharmacology and Biochemistry.





My mentor, Dr. Michael Sigel, was located most of the time at Variety Children's Research Foundation on the grounds of what is presently Miami Children's Hospital, but he also had a laboratory and an office in the Anastasia Building. This facility, with its old wooden floors, was not the most suitable environment to grow cells in tissue culture, but it was there that I worked. However, I commuted to the Jackson campus, since Dr. Dietrich, my former boss, functioned as a co-mentor for my dissertation research.

Nowadays, the original School of Medicine Building located on Anastasia Avenue is gone. It was razed when the new Biltmore Hotel was opened in the tower that had for years been used as the Veterans' Hospital of Miami, before this facility moved to its present location on N.W. 12th Avenue. However, I will never forget the long hours I spent in that location, and how I used to go for a walk along the edge of the golf course when my experiments did not work and all I wanted to do was sit down and cry. We should always keep in mind that research is based on one premise which is all important for budding, as well as established scientists: you search and search and search (that is why it is called research!) By following this premise, the time came when I started presenting my scientific findings at national and international meetings and I graduated with a Ph.D. degree in January of 1970. In those years, we used to have two graduating ceremonies a year, one in early January and one in late May or June. These were not always at the University's Coral Gables campus and my graduation was held at the City of Miami's Marine Stadium on Key Biscayne. It was a cool, windy morning and my husband, three children and my parents all accompanied me to receive my diploma. Drs. Sigel and Dietrich donned their regalia and were by my side for this momentous occasion. Since a large number of students were graduating only the Ph.D. candidates were formally robed and given their diplomas by the President. However, the stage at the Marine Stadium was a floating barge and I had to cross a flimsy board from the stands of the stadium to the floating stage. Fortunately, my fears of losing my cap as I walked the plank that was moving back and forth as the waves crashed against the stage were unfounded.

I began my career as a faculty member with the title of Instructor and was I ever proud of my new status. The University has continued to expand under its third president and research activities were emphasized. The new Rosenstiel Medical School Building had just opened as I graduated and I was assigned a laboratory on the third floor which I shared with Ann Beasley, who had collaborated with Dr. Sigel for years since they had worked together in Atlanta at the Center of Communicable Diseases (CDC). The years passed and my career continued to develop. When the new Cancer Center was approved and opened, initially under Dr. Lessner and soon thereafter under Dr. Gordon Zubrod's direction, I became Program Leader of Tumor Virology and Immunology of the Papanicolaou Cancer Center, now the University of Miami/Sylvester Comprehensive





Cancer Center. At approximately the same time, a new undergraduate major in Microbiology was implemented by our department under the leadership of Dr. Bennet Sallman, our chairman. I have taught on the Coral Gables campus since the inception of that program and have always enjoyed my interactions with the faculty and undergraduate students of the College of Arts and Sciences. The new Cox Science Building was a good place to have our classes but sometimes our venue was the Learning Center. During these years, I was privileged to serve as Senator representing the School of Medicine and thus became aware of the successes and problems on the Coral Gables campus and of the necessity for closer ties between the Coral Gables campus, the School of Medicine and the Rosenstiel School of Marine Sciences. Indeed, it was due to serving as a Senator that I met and came to appreciate the dedication, intellectuality, and the high caliber of ethics of my colleagues from the Schools of Law, Business Administration, Communications, Music, Architecture, Engineering and the College of Arts and Sciences.

Upon the retirement of Dr. Sallman as Chairman of Microbiology and Immunology, Dr. J. Wayne Streilein came to the University of Miami to assume the leadership of our department. Dean Fogel's mandate of developing the Immunology resources at the School of Medicine resulted in the establishment of ten new positions to recruit scientists in this discipline. This was accomplished for us, "the oldtimers", and it was like moving to a new department without having to pack anything!

And it was not just our department which developed so strikingly. The School of Medicine grew by leaps and bounds, evidenced not only by all of the new construction, but by the high caliber of the research and clinical activities on our campus and the high regard in which it is held throughout the United States. In addition to the traditional departments, centers focused on the cure of specific types of disease, such as the Cancer Center, have been instituted to draw from the talents of an interdisciplinary faculty. The Medical campus is hardly recognizable today to those who knew it in the 1970's. Instead of a street full of traffic and congestion, which was the condition of 10th Avenue, we have a beautiful pedestrian mall lined with wonderful new buildings such as the library and the Bascom Palmer Eye Institute anchored by the Ryder Trauma Center, recognized as one of the best of its kind in the nation, if not the world. The clinical facilities of the Sylvester Comprehensive Cancer Center are housed in a gorgeous building that has received several architectural awards. The recent completion of the building for the Miami Project to Cure Paralysis and the dedication of the Batchelor Building for Pediatric and Genetic Studies completes a complex that surrounds a beautifully landscaped plaza that is bounded by the Diabetes Research Institute, the Papanicolaou Research building of the Sylvester Comprehensive Cancer Center and the Gautier Research Building where the Department of Biochemistry and other facilities are located.





The University of Miami School of Medicine continues to thrive. These have been wonderful years during which I have become very attached to our wonderful University, and I tell my Chairman, "Since I do not plan to retire, God willing, I will continue to do research and teach, and if I am not able to walk well, I will just have to go after the medical students with my cane."¹¹¹



¹¹¹ Dr. Diana Lopez - Personal Recollections





DR. HENRY KING STANFORD



Dr. Henry King Stanford is the third president of the University of Miami and the third sponsor of Iron Arrow. He was tapped into the society on November 10, 1966, at “the old tapping tree,” and welcomed into membership by Chief Barry Richard.

I remember seeing Dr. Stanford wearing his Seminole jacket many times; at Homecoming when he would dance with the student Homecoming Queen, and again at Homecoming football games. He is a familiar figure at the head table of the tapping luncheons, and many are the faculty and alumni members of IA who have been tapped in the president’s office, where he had invited them on “important business that must be discussed in person.”

Dr. Stanford was instrumental in clearing the way for the tribe’s tapping mound and firebowl which now stand near the bookstore beneath a cool and spreading ficus tree. When the tribe proposed moving the statue of Dr. Ashe to the foyer of the Administration Building, Dr. Stanford’s help was decisive in allowing the Iron Arrow membership plaques to be placed alongside the statue.

Dr. Stanford’s contributions to Iron Arrow are many, but two, I think, are particularly important. First, it was Dr. Stanford who promoted the James Hutchinson Fund initiated by Eugene Cohen, to acquire 50 oil canvases to preserve for posterity much of the beauty and culture of the Seminole Indians. At this writing, several of these canvases hang in the Office of the President, immediately impressing upon official guests of the University the unique relationship of the





University community with the Everglades tribes. Aside from Eugene Cohen's role in establishing the fund at the University of Miami and Dr. Stanford's enthusiastic support of the project, recognition is also due John J. DuPuis, Jr., and Charlton Tebeau.

Dr. Stanford's second contribution to the Iron Arrow tradition is both gracious and popular. Each year at Homecoming, he and Mrs. Stanford host a reception for Iron Arrow members and guests in their home. This event was first held on October 27, 1971, in the old W. T. Grant mansion on South Bayshore Drive in Coconut Grove, the home of the first three presidents of the University and their families. The tradition continues and holds equal esteem in President and Mrs. Stanford's new home on Old Cutler Road near Matheson Hammock Park. I remember standing on Mrs. Stanford's sun porch with its touch of rattan-wicker decor and its profuse, vigorous assortment of tropical flora and looking out over a lawn alive with the thousand colors and patterns of Seminole jackets. On such warm autumn nights, the quiet elegance of times long past come to mind with every foliage-scented breath, and 1926, seems no further away than the shadows surrounding the lawn.

